


# Principles from Proverbs:

# Wisdom for Young People

A Study in the Book of Proverbs — Teacher Copy

**PLANTED YOUTH**

**Millheim Baptist Church**

# Introduction

The book of Proverbs was written by a father to his son, and God preserved it for every young person who wants to live wisely. It speaks directly to the choices of the teenage years: whom to listen to, whom to walk with, how to speak, how to handle anger, desire, work, and money, and which way to go in life.

These twelve lessons gather the teaching of Proverbs into broad subjects. Each lesson covers several related principles of wisdom, compares Proverbs with the rest of Scripture, and ends by pointing to the Lord Jesus Christ, who is made unto us wisdom (1 Corinthians 1:30).

> **Proverbs 1:7 —** *The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge: but fools despise wisdom and instruction.*

Read the listed passages, fill in each blank (answers are shown in red in this teacher copy), and use the charts to connect each principle with the proverbs that teach it. Proverbs has thirty-one chapters, so reading one chapter a day will take you through the book every month (see Appendix A).

# Lessons at a Glance

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UNIT 1 — THE FOUNDATION OF WISDOM

# Lesson 1 — The Beginning of Wisdom: The Fear of the LORD and the Two Ways

**Lesson Overview:** Solomon wrote Proverbs so that young people would receive wisdom, instruction, and discretion. The book begins with its foundation, the fear of the LORD, and then sets two paths before every young person: the way of wisdom and the way of folly. It also introduces the kinds of people who walk those paths: the wise, the simple, the fool, and the scorner.

**MAIN PASSAGES:** Proverbs 1:1–33; 2:1–22; 3:1–18; 4:10–27; 9:10

**KEY VERSE | Proverbs 1:7 —** *The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge: but fools despise wisdom and instruction.*

**READ:** Proverbs 1:1–33; 2:1–22; 3:1–18; 4:10–27; 9:1–18; 1 Kings 3:5–14; 4:29–34; Psalm 111:10; Ecclesiastes 12:13; James 1:5; 3:13–18.

### Wisdom from Proverbs

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Why Proverbs was written | Proverbs 1:4 — ***"To give subtilty to the simple, to the young man knowledge and discretion"*** |
| Where wisdom begins | Proverbs 9:10 — ***"The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom"*** |
| Where wisdom comes from | Proverbs 2:6 — ***"For the LORD giveth wisdom: out of his mouth cometh knowledge and understanding."*** |
| What wisdom is worth | Proverbs 3:15 — ***"She is more precious than rubies"*** |

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| The path of the just | Proverbs 4:18 — ***"But the path of the just is as the shining light, that shineth more and more unto the perfect day."*** |
| The way of the wicked | Proverbs 4:19 — ***"The way of the wicked is as darkness: they know not at what they stumble"*** |

## 1. Why God Gave Us Proverbs

God gave Solomon ***"wisdom and understanding exceeding much, and largeness of heart"***. Solomon spoke three thousand proverbs (1 Kings 4:32), and God preserved the ones He wanted us to have in this book. Proverbs states its own purpose in its first verses: to know wisdom and instruction, to receive the instruction of wisdom, justice, judgment, and equity, and ***"to the young man knowledge and discretion"***.

Proverbs is written as a father speaking to his son. Over and over the book says, "My **son**" (Proverbs 1:8; 2:1; 3:1; 4:1). That makes it one of the most direct books in the Bible for young people. It does not give wisdom for some distant future; it gives wisdom for the decisions a young person faces now: what to listen to, who to follow, how to speak, how to work, and what to do with desire, money, and time.

### Key Words in Proverbs 1:2–5

| Word | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Wisdom | Seeing life from God's point of view and living skillfully by it |
| Instruction | Teaching that corrects and disciplines |
| Understanding | Discerning the difference between right and wrong, true and false |
| Subtilty | Shrewdness; the ability to see through deception (Proverbs 1:4) |

| Word | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Discretion | Careful judgment that thinks before acting (Proverbs 2:11) |
| Learning | Continued growth, even for the wise (Proverbs 1:5) |

## 2. The Fear of the LORD

Everything in Proverbs rests on one foundation: ***"The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge: but fools despise wisdom and instruction"***. The fear of the LORD is not terror that runs from God; it is **reverence** that takes God seriously. It means living with the awareness that God sees, God speaks, and God will judge. A person may have a high IQ and a full education, but without the fear of the LORD he has not even begun to be wise.

Proverbs shows that the fear of the LORD shapes the whole of life. It turns a person away from evil, lengthens life, gives confidence, and becomes a fountain of life.

### What the Fear of the LORD Does

| Result | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Hates evil | Proverbs 8:13 — ***"The fear of the LORD is to hate evil"*** |
| Departs from evil | Proverbs 16:6 — ***"by the fear of the LORD men depart from evil"*** |
| Gives confidence | Proverbs 14:26 — ***"In the fear of the LORD is strong confidence"*** |
| Is a fountain of life | Proverbs 14:27 — ***"The fear of the LORD is a fountain of life, to depart from the snares of death"*** |
| Is better than riches | Proverbs 15:16 — ***"Better is little with the fear of the LORD than great treasure and trouble therewith."*** |

| Result | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Brings honour | Proverbs 22:4 — ***"By humility and the fear of the LORD are riches, and honour, and life."*** |

**Proverbs 3:5–6 —** *Trust in the LORD with all thine heart; and lean not unto thine own understanding. In all thy ways acknowledge him, and he shall direct thy paths.*

## 3. Two Ways and the People Who Walk Them

Proverbs presents life as a road with **two** directions. Wisdom calls in the streets and invites the simple to turn (Proverbs 1:20–23), while sinners entice the young man to join them (Proverbs 1:10–14). Chapter 9 pictures two women, Wisdom and Folly, each inviting the passerby into her house. Wisdom's house leads to life; of Folly's guests Solomon says, ***"he knoweth not that the dead are there"***.

Proverbs also describes the kinds of people found on these two roads. Learning to recognize them helps a young person see where he is and where he is headed.

### The People of Proverbs

| Person | Description | Proverb |
|---|---|---|
| The wise | Hears, fears God, receives correction, and keeps growing | Proverbs 1:5; 9:9 |
| The simple | Naive and easily led; believes every word | Proverbs 14:15; 22:3 |
| The fool | Trusts his own heart and despises instruction | Proverbs 12:15; 28:26 |
| The scorner | Mocks correction and spreads contempt | Proverbs 9:7–8; 13:1 |
| The sluggard | Lazy, full of excuses, and always wanting | Proverbs 13:4; 26:13–16 |
| The prudent | Foresees danger and acts carefully | Proverbs 14:8; 22:3 |

The good news is that no one is locked on a path. Wisdom calls, ***"Turn you at my reproof"***, and promises, ***"those that seek me early shall find me"***.

## Check Your Understanding

1. According to Proverbs 1:1–6, why did God give the book of Proverbs?
2. What does it mean to fear the LORD, and why is it the beginning of wisdom?
3. List four results of the fear of the LORD from Proverbs.
4. Describe the two invitations in Proverbs 9 and where each one leads.
5. Name and describe four kinds of people found in Proverbs.

UNIT 1 — THE FOUNDATION OF WISDOM

# Lesson 2 — Hear, My Son: Parents, Correction, and a Teachable Spirit

**Lesson Overview:** The first human voice Proverbs tells a young person to listen to is the voice of his parents. Proverbs teaches that honoring father and mother, receiving correction, and staying teachable are marks of wisdom, while pride, scorn, and rebellion lead to ruin. This lesson covers three connected principles: honor your parents, love correction, and walk in humility.

**MAIN PASSAGES:** Proverbs 1:8–9; 4:1–13; 6:20–23; 12:1; 13:1; 15:5, 31–33; 16:18–19

**KEY VERSE | Proverbs 1:8 —** *My son, hear the instruction of thy father, and forsake not the law of thy mother:*

**READ:** Exodus 20:12; Proverbs 1:8–9; 3:11–12; 4:1–13; 6:20–23; 9:7–9; 10:1, 17; 11:2; 12:1, 15; 13:1, 18; 15:5, 10, 20, 31–33; 16:18–19; 19:20, 26; 20:20; 23:22–25; 29:1, 23; 30:17; Ephesians 6:1–3; Hebrews 12:5–11.

### Wisdom from Proverbs

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Hear your father | Proverbs 4:1 — ***"Hear, ye children, the instruction of a father"*** |
| Honor your mother | Proverbs 23:22 — ***"Hearken unto thy father that begat thee, and despise not thy mother when she is old."*** |
| Love correction | Proverbs 12:1 — ***"Whoso loveth instruction loveth knowledge: but he that hateth reproof is brutish."*** |

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| A wise son gladdens | Proverbs 10:1 — ***"A wise son maketh a glad father"*** |
| Pride goes before a fall | Proverbs 16:18 — ***"Pride goeth before destruction, and an haughty spirit before a fall."*** |
| Humility before honour | Proverbs 15:33 — ***"and before honour is humility"*** |

## 1. Honor Your Father and Mother

Proverbs opens its teaching with the home: ***"My son, hear the instruction of thy father, and forsake not the law of thy mother"***. God gave parents the first responsibility to teach their children, and He gave children the responsibility to hear. Their instruction is described as ***"an ornament of grace unto thy head, and chains about thy neck"***. Obedience is not a burden that limits a young person; it is a crown that adorns him.

The father in Proverbs 4 passes on what his own father taught him (Proverbs 4:3–4). Godly instruction is meant to move from generation to generation. Proverbs 6:20–23 says that a parent's commandment will lead, keep, and talk with the young person, ***"For the commandment is a lamp; and the law is light"***. The New Testament repeats the command with a promise: ***"Honour thy father and mother; which is the first commandment with promise"***.

### Honor and Dishonor Toward Parents

| The wise child | The foolish child | Proverb |
|---|---|---|
| Hears instruction | Despises his mother | Proverbs 15:20 |
| Makes his father glad | Is a heaviness to his mother | Proverbs 10:1 |
| Keeps the commandment | Curses father or mother; his lamp is put out | Proverbs 6:20; 20:20 |

| The wise child | The foolish child | Proverb |
|---|---|---|
| Brings joy to those who begat him | Mocks and despises obedience | Proverbs 23:24–25; 30:17 |

## 2. Love Correction

Nobody enjoys being corrected, but Proverbs is blunt: ***"he that hateth reproof is brutish"***. The difference between a wise person and a fool is not that the wise never make mistakes. It is that the wise receive correction and grow, while the fool rejects it and stays the same. ***"Give instruction to a wise man, and he will be yet wiser"***.

Correction may come from parents, pastors, teachers, or friends, and ultimately it comes from God Himself. ***"For whom the LORD loveth he correcteth; even as a father the son in whom he delighteth"***. Hebrews 12 quotes this proverb and explains that God's chastening is proof that He treats us as sons (Hebrews 12:5–8).

### How the Wise and the Fool Respond to Correction

| The wise | The fool or scorner | Proverb |
|---|---|---|
| Loves instruction | Hates reproof | Proverbs 12:1 |
| Hearkens unto counsel | Is right in his own eyes | Proverbs 12:15 |
| Regards reproof and is prudent | Despises his father's instruction | Proverbs 15:5 |
| Loves the one who rebukes him | Hates the one who rebukes him | Proverbs 9:8 |
| Is honoured | Comes to poverty and shame | Proverbs 13:18 |

> **Proverbs 29:1 —** *He, that being often reproved hardeneth his neck, shall suddenly be destroyed, and that without remedy.*

## 3. Pride and Humility

The root of an unteachable spirit is **pride**. Pride says, "I already know," "I don't need anyone," and "No one can tell me what to do." Proverbs warns that ***"When pride cometh, then cometh shame: but with the lowly is wisdom"***. Among the seven things the LORD hates, the first listed is ***"A proud look"*** (Proverbs 6:16–17).

Humility is not thinking poorly of yourself; it is thinking rightly of God and honestly of yourself. The humble person knows he needs God, needs counsel, and needs correction. ***"Surely he scorneth the scorners: but he giveth grace unto the lowly"***. James and Peter both quote this verse (James 4:6; 1 Peter 5:5), showing that the principle holds for believers today.

### Pride and Humility in Proverbs

| Pride | Humility | Proverb |
|---|---|---|
| Goes before destruction | Comes before honour | Proverbs 16:18; 18:12 |
| Brings shame | Brings wisdom | Proverbs 11:2 |
| Is an abomination to the LORD | Receives grace from the LORD | Proverbs 16:5; 3:34 |
| Brings a man low | Upholds the humble in spirit | Proverbs 29:23 |
| Breeds contention | Takes counsel | Proverbs 13:10 |

## Check Your Understanding

1. What does Proverbs 1:8–9 teach about a young person's responsibility to parents?
2. According to Proverbs 6:20–23, what does a parent's commandment do for a young person?
3. How do the wise and the foolish respond differently to correction? Give three contrasts.
4. What does Proverbs 3:11–12 teach about God's correction, and how does Hebrews 12 apply it?
5. Why is pride the root of an unteachable spirit? Use two proverbs in your answer.

UNIT 1 — THE FOUNDATION OF WISDOM

# Lesson 3 — Keep Thy Heart: Thoughts, Trust, and Contentment

**Lesson Overview:** Proverbs teaches that life flows out of the heart. What a young person thinks about, trusts in, and desires will shape the words he speaks and the path he walks. This lesson covers three inner principles of wisdom: guard the heart and mind, trust the LORD rather than your own understanding, and replace envy and discontent with a sound and cheerful heart.

**MAIN PASSAGES:** Proverbs 3:5–8; 4:20–27; 14:30; 23:17–19; 24:1–2, 19–20; 28:26

**KEY VERSE | Proverbs 4:23 —** *Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life.*

**READ:** Proverbs 3:5–8; 4:20–27; 12:25; 14:10, 13, 30; 15:13–15; 16:2, 9; 17:22; 18:14; 20:27; 21:2; 23:7, 17–19; 24:1–2, 19–20; 27:19; 28:26; Jeremiah 17:9–10; Matthew 15:18–19; Philippians 4:6–8.

### Wisdom from Proverbs

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Guard the heart | Proverbs 4:23 — ***"Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life."*** |
| Thoughts shape a man | Proverbs 23:7 — ***"For as he thinketh in his heart, so is he"*** |
| Trust the LORD | Proverbs 3:5 — ***"Trust in the LORD with all thine heart; and lean not unto thine own understanding."*** |

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Do not trust yourself | Proverbs 28:26 — ***"He that trusteth in his own heart is a fool"*** |
| Envy destroys | Proverbs 14:30 — ***"A sound heart is the life of the flesh: but envy the rottenness of the bones"*** |
| A merry heart heals | Proverbs 17:22 — ***"A merry heart doeth good like a medicine"*** |

## 1. Guard Your Heart and Mind

Proverbs 4:20–27 gives a complete guard for the inner life. The father tells his son to keep God's words in the midst of his heart (Proverbs 4:21), and then says, ***"Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life"***. In the Bible the heart is the **inner** man: the mind, the will, and the affections. Whatever fills it will eventually flow out of it.

The passage continues by guarding the mouth, the eyes, and the feet (Proverbs 4:24–27). What we say, what we look at, and where we go all affect the heart. A young person who guards those gates guards his heart. The Lord Jesus taught the same truth: ***"For out of the heart proceed evil thoughts, murders, adulteries, fornications, thefts, false witness, blasphemies"***.

### The Guard of Proverbs 4:20–27

| Gate | Command | Verse |
|---|---|---|
| The ears | Incline thine ear unto my sayings | Proverbs 4:20 |
| The heart | Keep thy heart with all diligence | Proverbs 4:23 |
| The mouth | Put away from thee a froward mouth | Proverbs 4:24 |
| The eyes | Let thine eyes look right on | Proverbs 4:25 |

| Gate | Command | Verse |
|---|---|---|
| The feet | Ponder the path of thy feet; remove thy foot from evil | Proverbs 4:26–27 |

## 2. Trust in the LORD, Not in Yourself

Proverbs 3:5–6 may be the best-known passage in the book. It calls for trust in the LORD ***"with all thine heart"***, not part of it. It warns, ***"lean not unto thine own understanding"***. Human understanding is limited and often deceived. ***"There is a way which seemeth right unto a man, but the end thereof are the ways of death"***.

The heart that trusts itself is the heart of a fool (Proverbs 28:26). Jeremiah says the heart ***"is deceitful above all things, and desperately wicked"***. The popular advice to "follow your heart" is the opposite of Proverbs. The wise young person acknowledges God in all his ways, and God promises, ***"he shall direct thy paths"***.

### Trusting Self Versus Trusting God

| Trusting self | Trusting God | Proverb |
|---|---|---|
| Leans on his own understanding | Trusts the LORD with all his heart | Proverbs 3:5 |
| Is wise in his own eyes | Fears the LORD and departs from evil | Proverbs 3:7 |
| Takes a way that seems right | Acknowledges God in all his ways | Proverbs 14:12; 3:6 |
| Is a fool | Shall be delivered | Proverbs 28:26 |
| Weighs his own ways as clean | Lets the LORD weigh the spirits | Proverbs 16:2 |

## 3. Envy, Discontent, and a Cheerful Heart

Envy is one of the most common heart sins among young people, and it grows when we constantly see what others have. Proverbs warns three times against envying the wicked (Proverbs 3:31; 23:17; 24:1, 19). The wicked may seem to prosper, but ***"For there shall be no reward to the evil man; the candle of the wicked shall be put out"***. Envy does not hurt the one envied; it **rots** the one who envies (Proverbs 14:30).

The cure for envy is a heart that is fixed on the LORD and satisfied with Him: ***"Let not thine heart envy sinners: but be thou in the fear of the LORD all the day long"***. Proverbs also speaks honestly about heaviness of heart and shows the value of a good word and a merry heart.

### The Condition of the Heart

| Heart condition | Result | Proverb |
|---|---|---|
| Heaviness | Makes the heart stoop; a good word makes it glad | Proverbs 12:25 |
| Sorrow | Breaks the spirit | Proverbs 15:13 |
| Merry heart | Makes a cheerful countenance; a continual feast | Proverbs 15:13, 15 |
| Envy | Rottenness of the bones | Proverbs 14:30 |
| Sound heart | The life of the flesh | Proverbs 14:30 |

> **Proverbs 15:16 —** *Better is little with the fear of the LORD than great treasure and trouble therewith.*

## Check Your Understanding

1. What is the “heart” in Scripture, and why must it be kept with all diligence?
2. List the five gates guarded in Proverbs 4:20–27.
3. Why is “follow your heart” the opposite of Proverbs 3:5–6 and 28:26?
4. What does Proverbs teach about envying the wicked? Give two references.
5. According to Proverbs 12:25, 15:13, and 17:22, how does the condition of the heart affect a person?

UNIT 2 — WISDOM IN RELATIONSHIPS

# Lesson 4 — Choose Your Companions: Friends, Peer Pressure, and Loyalty

**Lesson Overview:** Proverbs teaches that a young person will become like the people he walks with. The very first warning the father gives is about companions who entice him to sin. This lesson covers three principles: refuse the enticement of sinners, choose companions who make you wiser, and be the kind of faithful friend Proverbs describes.

**MAIN PASSAGES:** Proverbs 1:10–19; 4:14–19; 13:20; 17:17; 18:24; 22:24–25; 27:5–6, 9–10, 17

**KEY VERSE | Proverbs 13:20 —** *He that walketh with wise men shall be wise: but a companion of fools shall be destroyed.*

**READ:** Proverbs 1:10–19; 4:14–19; 12:26; 13:20; 14:7; 16:28–29; 17:9, 17; 18:24; 19:4, 6–7; 20:19; 22:24–25; 23:20–21; 24:1–2, 21; 27:5–6, 9–10, 17; 28:7; 1 Samuel 18:1–4; 1 Corinthians 15:33.

### Wisdom from Proverbs

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Say no to enticement | Proverbs 1:10 — ***"My son, if sinners entice thee, consent thou not."*** |
| Companions shape you | Proverbs 13:20 — ***"He that walketh with wise men shall be wise: but a companion of fools shall be destroyed."*** |
| Avoid the angry | Proverbs 22:24 — ***"Make no friendship with an angry man; and with a furious man thou shalt not go"*** |

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| A friend loves always | Proverbs 17:17 — ***"A friend loveth at all times"*** |
| Friends sharpen | Proverbs 27:17 — ***"Iron sharpeneth iron; so a man sharpeneth the countenance of his friend."*** |
| Be friendly | Proverbs 18:24 — ***"A man that hath friends must shew himself friendly"*** |

## 1. When Sinners Entice Thee

The father's first warning in Proverbs is about **peer pressure**: ***"My son, if sinners entice thee, consent thou not"***. The sinners in Proverbs 1 promise excitement, belonging, and gain. They say, ***"Cast in thy lot among us; let us all have one purse"***. The appeal is not only to the sin itself but to being part of the group.

Proverbs exposes where that path leads. The ones who lay wait for others ***"lurk privily for their own lives"***. The father does not say to go along a little way and then turn back; he says, ***"walk not thou in the way with them; refrain thy foot from their path"***. Proverbs 4:15 adds, ***"Avoid it, pass not by it, turn from it, and pass away"***.

### The Enticement of Proverbs 1:10–19

| What sinners offer | What really happens | Verse |
|---|---|---|
| Excitement: "Come with us" | They run to evil and make haste to shed blood | Proverbs 1:11, 16 |
| Belonging: "Cast in thy lot among us" | They lay wait for their own blood | Proverbs 1:14, 18 |
| Gain: "We shall find all precious substance" | Greed takes away the life of its owners | Proverbs 1:13, 19 |

> **Proverbs 4:14 —** *Enter not into the path of the wicked, and go not in the way of evil men*

## 2. Choose Companions Who Make You Wiser

Proverbs 13:20 states a principle that never fails: ***"He that walketh with wise men shall be wise: but a companion of fools shall be destroyed"***. Companions do not merely influence opinions; they shape **habits**, speech, desires, and direction. ***"Be not deceived: evil communications corrupt good manners"***.

Proverbs names specific kinds of people to avoid as close companions. This does not mean refusing to be kind to them or to witness to them. It means refusing to let them set the direction of your life. ***"The righteous is more excellent than his neighbour: but the way of the wicked seduceth them"***.

### Companions to Avoid

| Companion | Why | Proverb |
|---|---|---|
| The angry man | Lest thou learn his ways and get a snare to thy soul | Proverbs 22:24–25 |
| The foolish man | You will not find knowledge in him | Proverbs 14:7 |
| The talebearer | He reveals secrets; meddle not with him | Proverbs 20:19 |
| The riotous and gluttonous | A companion of riotous men shameth his father | Proverbs 23:20–21; 28:7 |
| Those given to change | Rebellion brings sudden calamity | Proverbs 24:21–22 |

## 3. Be a Faithful Friend

Proverbs not only tells young people whom to avoid; it describes what a true friend looks like. A true friend is loyal in hard times, honest when honesty hurts, and present when

needed. ***"Faithful are the wounds of a friend; but the kisses of an enemy are deceitful"***. A friend who flatters you into sin is no friend at all.

Proverbs also warns about the false friendships that come with money and popularity (Proverbs 19:4, 6–7) and about the things that destroy friendships: gossip and repeating a matter (Proverbs 16:28; 17:9). The best friendships are built on love that **covers** a transgression rather than spreading it. The greatest Friend of all is the Lord Jesus, who said, ***"Ye are my friends, if ye do whatsoever I command you"***.

### Marks of a Faithful Friend

| Mark | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Loves at all times | Proverbs 17:17 |
| Sticks closer than a brother | Proverbs 18:24 |
| Tells the truth | Proverbs 27:5–6 |
| Gives hearty counsel | Proverbs 27:9 — ***"so doth the sweetness of a man's friend by hearty counsel"*** |
| Sharpens his friend | Proverbs 27:17 |
| Covers a transgression | Proverbs 17:9 |
| Stays loyal to family friends | Proverbs 27:10 |

> **Proverbs 17:9 —** *He that covereth a transgression seeketh love; but he that repeateth a matter separateth very friends*

## Check Your Understanding

1. What three things did the sinners of Proverbs 1 offer, and what really happened to them?
2. Explain Proverbs 13:20 in your own words and connect it to 1 Corinthians 15:33.
3. Name three kinds of companions Proverbs warns against and why.
4. Why are the “wounds of a friend” better than the “kisses of an enemy”?
5. List five marks of a faithful friend. Which one do you most need to grow in?

UNIT 2 — WISDOM IN RELATIONSHIPS

# Lesson 5 — The Strange Woman and the Virtuous Woman: Purity, Dating, and Marriage

**Lesson Overview:** Proverbs devotes more space to sexual purity than to almost any other subject. Chapters 5, 6, and 7 warn the young man about the strange woman, and chapter 31 describes the virtuous woman. Together they teach young men and young women to guard their purity, recognize the tactics of temptation, value character above appearance, and look forward to God's gift of marriage.

**MAIN PASSAGES:** Proverbs 2:16–19; 5:1–23; 6:20–35; 7:1–27; 31:10–31

**KEY VERSE | Proverbs 31:30 —** *Favour is deceitful, and beauty is vain: but a woman that feareth the LORD, she shall be praised.*

**READ:** Proverbs 2:10–19; 5:1–23; 6:20–35; 7:1–27; 11:16, 22; 12:4; 18:22; 19:14; 21:9, 19; 22:14; 23:26–28; 31:10–31; Genesis 39:7–12; 1 Corinthians 6:18–20; 1 Thessalonians 4:3–7; 1 Timothy 5:1–2.

## Wisdom from Proverbs

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Stay far away | Proverbs 5:8 — ***"Remove thy way far from her, and come not nigh the door of her house:"*** |
| Guard the heart and eyes | Proverbs 6:25 — ***"Lust not after her beauty in thine heart; neither let her take thee with her eyelids"*** |
| Sin always costs | Proverbs 6:27 — ***"Can a man take fire in his bosom, and his clothes not be burned?"*** |

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Rejoice in God's gift | Proverbs 5:18 — ***"rejoice with the wife of thy youth"*** |
| A good wife is from the LORD | Proverbs 18:22 — ***"Whoso findeth a wife findeth a good thing, and obtaineth favour of the LORD."*** |
| Character over beauty | Proverbs 31:30 — ***"Favour is deceitful, and beauty is vain: but a woman that feareth the LORD, she shall be praised"*** |

## 1. The Tactics of Temptation (Proverbs 7)

Proverbs 7 is a detailed picture of how sexual temptation works. The father looks through his window and sees ***"among the youths, a young man void of understanding"***. The young man is not dragged into sin; he wanders toward it, walking near her corner in the twilight (Proverbs 7:8–9). He puts himself where temptation is waiting.

The strange woman uses flattery, boldness, secrecy, and the promise that no one will know (Proverbs 7:13–20). ***"With her much fair speech she caused him to yield, with the flattering of her lips she forced him"***. The young man follows ***"as an ox goeth to the slaughter"***. The chapter ends with a sober warning: ***"Her house is the way to hell, going down to the chambers of death"***. The same tactics appear today in the images, messages, and media that lure young people into impurity.

### The Steps of Proverbs 7

| Step | What happened | Verse |
|---|---|---|
| Simple | A young man void of understanding | Proverbs 7:7 |
| Wandering | He went the way to her house | Proverbs 7:8 |
| In the dark | In the twilight, in the black and dark night | Proverbs 7:9 |
| Met | She caught him and kissed him | Proverbs 7:10–13 |

| Step | What happened | Verse |
|---|---|---|
| Flattered | Fair speech and the promise of secrecy | Proverbs 7:14–21 |
| Captured | He goeth after her straightway | Proverbs 7:22–23 |

## 2. The Cost of Impurity (Proverbs 5–6)

The strange woman's words are ***"smoother than oil"***, ***"But her end is bitter as wormwood"***. Sexual sin always promises more than it gives and takes more than it promises. Proverbs lists its cost: honour given to others, years wasted, strength spent, and mourning at the end (Proverbs 5:9–11).

The father's command is simple: ***"Remove thy way far from her, and come not nigh the door of her house"***. **Distance** is the best defense. Joseph fled from Potiphar's wife (Genesis 39:12), and Paul commands, ***"Flee fornication"***. These warnings apply equally to young women, who must guard their own hearts and refuse to become a snare to others. ***"As a jewel of gold in a swine's snout, so is a fair woman which is without discretion"***.

### What Impurity Costs

| Cost | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Honour and years given away | Proverbs 5:9 |
| Strength and wealth spent on strangers | Proverbs 5:10 |
| Mourning and regret at the end | Proverbs 5:11–13 |
| Held by the cords of one's own sins | Proverbs 5:22 |
| A wound and dishonour that will not be wiped away | Proverbs 6:32–33 |
| Death and hell | Proverbs 7:26–27 |

> **Proverbs 6:23 —** *For the commandment is a lamp; and the law is light; and reproofs of instruction are the way of life*

## 3. The Virtuous Woman and the Gift of Marriage

Proverbs does not only warn; it points young people toward something good. ***"Whoso findeth a wife findeth a good thing, and obtaineth favour of the LORD"***. ***"a prudent wife is from the LORD"***. Marriage is God's gift, and purity before marriage protects the joy of marriage (Proverbs 5:15–19).

Proverbs 31:10–31 describes the virtuous woman. She is trustworthy, hardworking, generous, wise in speech, and above all she fears the LORD. Her description gives young women a goal to become, and it gives young men a standard for the kind of wife to seek and the kind of man worth her trust. In a culture that measures people by appearance, Proverbs says, ***"Favour is deceitful, and beauty is vain"***.

### The Virtuous Woman (Proverbs 31:10–31)

| Quality | Verse |
|---|---|
| Trustworthy: her husband safely trusts in her | Proverbs 31:11–12 |
| Diligent: she works willingly with her hands | Proverbs 31:13–19, 27 |
| Generous: she stretches out her hand to the poor | Proverbs 31:20 |
| Strong and honourable | Proverbs 31:25 |
| Wise and kind in speech | Proverbs 31:26 |
| Fears the LORD | Proverbs 31:30 |

## Check Your Understanding

1. Trace the steps of the young man in Proverbs 7. Where could he have stopped?
2. What tactics did the strange woman use, and how do the same tactics appear today?
3. List four costs of sexual impurity from Proverbs 5–7.
4. What is the best defense against sexual temptation according to Proverbs 5:8 and 1 Corinthians 6:18?
5. What qualities of the virtuous woman in Proverbs 31 matter most, and why is beauty called vain?

UNIT 2 — WISDOM IN RELATIONSHIPS

# Lesson 6 — Life and Death in the Tongue: Words, Lies, and Gossip

**Lesson Overview:** Proverbs has more to say about the tongue than almost any other book of the Bible. Words can build or destroy, heal or wound, tell the truth or spread lies. These principles apply to every conversation, text, post, and comment. This lesson covers the power of words, the sins of the tongue, and the marks of wise speech.

**MAIN PASSAGES:** Proverbs 10:19–21; 12:17–22; 15:1–4; 16:24–28; 18:6–8, 21; 26:18–28

**KEY VERSE | Proverbs 18:21 —** *Death and life are in the power of the tongue: and they that love it shall eat the fruit thereof.*

**READ:** Proverbs 4:24; 6:16–19; 10:11, 18–21, 31–32; 11:9, 12–13; 12:18–19, 22, 25; 13:3; 15:1–4, 23, 28; 16:24, 27–28; 17:27–28; 18:6–8, 13, 21; 20:19; 21:23; 25:11; 26:18–28; 27:1–2; 29:5, 20; James 3:1–12; Ephesians 4:29.

## Wisdom from Proverbs

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Words carry power | Proverbs 18:21 — ***"Death and life are in the power of the tongue"*** |
| Fewer words, less sin | Proverbs 10:19 — ***"In the multitude of words there wanteth not sin"*** |
| Soft answers calm | Proverbs 15:1 — ***"A soft answer turneth away wrath: but grievous words stir up anger."*** |
| Lies are abomination | Proverbs 12:22 — ***"Lying lips are abomination to the LORD"*** |

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Gossip divides | Proverbs 16:28 — ***"a whisperer separateth chief friends"*** |
| Kind words heal | Proverbs 16:24 — ***"Pleasant words are as an honeycomb, sweet to the soul, and health to the bones."*** |

## 1. The Power of Words

Proverbs teaches that words are never neutral. ***"There is that speaketh like the piercings of a sword: but the tongue of the wise is health"***. ***"A wholesome tongue is a tree of life"***. A single sentence can encourage someone for years or wound someone for years. The same is true of words typed and sent.

Because words carry such power, Proverbs commends restraint. ***"He that keepeth his mouth keepeth his life"***. ***"Even a fool, when he holdeth his peace, is counted wise"***. The wise person thinks before he speaks: ***"The heart of the righteous studieth to answer"***.

### Words That Build and Words That Destroy

| Words that build | Words that destroy | Proverb |
|---|---|---|
| The tongue of the wise is health | Speech like the piercings of a sword | Proverbs 12:18 |
| A wholesome tongue is a tree of life | Perverseness is a breach in the spirit | Proverbs 15:4 |
| A good word makes the heart glad | Heaviness makes it stoop | Proverbs 12:25 |
| Pleasant words are as an honeycomb | An ungodly man's lips are as a burning fire | Proverbs 16:24, 27 |

| Words that build | Words that destroy | Proverb |
|---|---|---|
| A word fitly spoken is like apples of gold | A flattering mouth worketh ruin | Proverbs 25:11; 26:28 |

## 2. Sins of the Tongue

Of the seven things the LORD hates in Proverbs 6:16–19, three involve the **tongue**: ***"a lying tongue"***, ***"A false witness that speaketh lies"***, and ***"he that soweth discord among brethren"***. God takes speech seriously because truth matters to Him. ***"The lip of truth shall be established for ever: but a lying tongue is but for a moment"***.

Gossip is especially destructive among young people. ***"The words of a talebearer are as wounds, and they go down into the innermost parts of the belly"***. Gossip spreads like fire, and Proverbs gives the way to put it out: ***"Where no wood is, there the fire goeth out: so where there is no talebearer, the strife ceaseth"***.

### Sins of the Tongue in Proverbs

| Sin | Description | Proverb |
|---|---|---|
| Lying | Abomination to the LORD; lasts but for a moment | Proverbs 12:19, 22 |
| Gossip (talebearing) | Reveals secrets and wounds deeply | Proverbs 11:13; 18:8 |
| Sowing discord | Stirs up strife between friends | Proverbs 6:19; 16:28 |
| Flattery | Spreads a net for the neighbour's feet | Proverbs 29:5 |
| Boasting | Praising oneself instead of letting another do it | Proverbs 27:1–2 |
| Hasty words | There is more hope of a fool | Proverbs 29:20 |

| Sin | Description | Proverb |
|---|---|---|
| Answering before hearing | It is folly and shame | Proverbs 18:13 |

## 3. The Marks of Wise Speech

Proverbs does not simply tell young people to stop speaking; it teaches them to speak well. Wise speech is truthful, timely, gentle, and helpful. ***"A word fitly spoken is like apples of gold in pictures of silver". "a word spoken in due season, how good is it!"***

The New Testament gives the same standard for the believer: ***"Let no corrupt communication proceed out of your mouth, but that which is good to the use of edifying, that it may minister grace unto the hearers"***. James warns that no man can tame the tongue by his own strength (James 3:8). Wise speech comes from a heart filled with God's Word and yielded to God's Spirit.

### Tests for Every Word, Text, and Post

| Test | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Is it true? | Proverbs 12:19, 22 |
| Is it necessary, or am I talking too much? | Proverbs 10:19; 17:27 |
| Have I heard the whole matter first? | Proverbs 18:13 |
| Is it gentle, or will it stir up anger? | Proverbs 15:1 |
| Is it the right time? | Proverbs 15:23; 25:11 |
| Would it spread something I should cover? | Proverbs 11:13; 17:9 |

**Proverbs 21:23 —** *Whoso keepeth his mouth and his tongue keepeth his soul from troubles.*

## Check Your Understanding

1. What does Proverbs 18:21 mean, and how does it apply to texting and posting?
2. Which three of the seven things the LORD hates involve the tongue?
3. How does Proverbs 26:20 teach us to stop gossip?
4. List four sins of the tongue from Proverbs with a reference for each.
5. Give four tests from Proverbs that every word should pass before it is spoken or sent.

UNIT 3 — WISDOM IN SELF-CONTROL

# Lesson 7 — Ruling Your Spirit: Anger, Strife, and Revenge

**Lesson Overview:** Proverbs praises the person who can control himself more than the one who can conquer a city. Anger, arguments, grudges, and revenge are some of the most common struggles for young people, and Proverbs addresses each one. This lesson covers three principles: be slow to anger, avoid and end strife, and leave vengeance to God.

**MAIN PASSAGES:** Proverbs 14:17, 29; 15:1, 18; 16:32; 17:14; 19:11; 20:3, 22; 25:21–28

**KEY VERSE | Proverbs 16:32 —** *He that is slow to anger is better than the mighty; and he that ruleth his spirit than he that taketh a city.*

**READ:** Proverbs 10:12; 12:16; 14:16–17, 29; 15:1, 18; 16:32; 17:14, 19; 18:19; 19:11, 19; 20:3, 22; 22:24–25; 24:17–18, 29; 25:21–22, 28; 26:17, 21; 29:8, 11, 22; 30:33; Romans 12:17–21; Ephesians 4:26–32; James 1:19–20.

### Wisdom from Proverbs

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Slow to anger is strength | Proverbs 16:32 — ***"He that is slow to anger is better than the mighty"*** |
| No self-control, no defense | Proverbs 25:28 — ***"He that hath no rule over his own spirit is like a city that is broken down, and without walls."*** |
| Overlook offenses | Proverbs 19:11 — ***"it is his glory to pass over a transgression"*** |

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Stop strife early | Proverbs 17:14 — ***"leave off contention, before it be meddled with"*** |
| Leave revenge to God | Proverbs 20:22 — ***"Say not thou, I will recompense evil; but wait on the LORD, and he shall save thee."*** |
| Repay evil with good | Proverbs 25:21 — ***"If thine enemy be hungry, give him bread to eat"*** |

## 1. Slow to Anger

The world praises the person who wins every argument and never backs down. Proverbs praises something greater: ***"He that is slow to anger is better than the mighty; and he that ruleth his spirit than he that taketh a city"***. Ruling your own spirit takes more strength than conquering an army.

A person without self-control is defenseless: ***"He that hath no rule over his own spirit is like a city that is broken down, and without walls"***. Anger that is quick and uncontrolled leads to foolish words and actions. ***"He that is soon angry dealeth foolishly"***. ***"A fool uttereth all his mind: but a wise man keepeth it in till afterwards"***.

### The Quick-Tempered and the Slow to Anger

| Quick-tempered | Slow to anger | Proverb |
|---|---|---|
| Deals foolishly | Has great understanding | Proverbs 14:17, 29 |
| Stirs up strife | Appeases strife | Proverbs 15:18 |
| Exalts folly | Is better than the mighty | Proverbs 14:29; 16:32 |
| Utters all his mind | Keeps it in till afterwards | Proverbs 29:11 |

| Quick-tempered | Slow to anger | Proverb |
|---|---|---|
| Will suffer punishment again and again | Passes over a transgression | Proverbs 19:19, 11 |

## 2. Avoiding and Ending Strife

Proverbs compares strife to a leak in a dam: ***"The beginning of strife is as when one letteth out water"***. The time to stop it is at the beginning, before it becomes a flood. ***"It is an honour for a man to cease from strife: but every fool will be meddling"***. Walking away from a fight is not weakness; Proverbs calls it honour.

Proverbs also identifies what feeds strife: pride (Proverbs 13:10), gossip (Proverbs 26:20), hatred (Proverbs 10:12), and meddling in quarrels that are not our business. ***"He that passeth by, and meddleth with strife belonging not to him, is like one that taketh a dog by the ears"***. The antidote is love: ***"Hatred stirreth up strifes: but love covereth all sins"***.

### What Feeds Strife and What Stops It

| Feeds strife | Stops strife | Proverb |
|---|---|---|
| Pride | Taking counsel | Proverbs 13:10 |
| Grievous words | A soft answer | Proverbs 15:1 |
| A talebearer | Removing the wood | Proverbs 26:20 |
| Hatred | Love that covers | Proverbs 10:12 |
| Meddling | Leaving off contention early | Proverbs 26:17; 17:14 |
| Forcing wrath | Refusing to churn it | Proverbs 30:33 |

## 3. Leave Vengeance to God

When someone wrongs us, the natural response is to get even. Proverbs forbids it: ***"Say not, I will do so to him as he hath done to me: I will render to the man according to his work"***. Instead, ***"wait on the LORD, and he shall save thee"***. Even when an enemy falls, the wise do not gloat (Proverbs 24:17–18).

Proverbs goes further and commands kindness toward enemies: ***"If thine enemy be hungry, give him bread to eat; and if he be thirsty, give him water to drink"***. Paul quotes this proverb in Romans 12:20 and concludes, ***"Be not overcome of evil, but overcome evil with good"***. The Lord Jesus is the perfect example: ***"when he was reviled, reviled not again; when he suffered, he threatened not; but committed himself to him that judgeth righteously"***.

### Responding to Wrongs God's Way

| Response | Scripture |
|---|---|
| Do not repay evil for evil | Proverbs 20:22; 24:29 |
| Do not rejoice when an enemy falls | Proverbs 24:17–18 |
| Do good to your enemy | Proverbs 25:21–22; Romans 12:20 |
| Wait on the LORD | Proverbs 20:22 |
| Commit yourself to the righteous Judge | 1 Peter 2:23 |

> **Proverbs 24:17 —** *Rejoice not when thine enemy falleth, and let not thine heart be glad when he stumbleth:*

## Check Your Understanding

1. Why does Proverbs 16:32 say ruling your spirit is greater than taking a city?
2. Compare the quick-tempered person with the one who is slow to anger. Give three contrasts.
3. What does Proverbs 17:14 teach about the best time to stop strife?
4. Name four things that feed strife and what Proverbs says stops each one.
5. How do Proverbs 25:21–22 and Romans 12:17–21 teach us to respond to an enemy?

UNIT 3 — WISDOM IN SELF-CONTROL

# Lesson 8 — Wine Is a Mocker: Alcohol, Substances, and Appetites

**Lesson Overview:** Alcohol, vaping, marijuana, and other substances are pressed on young people as normal, fun, and harmless. Proverbs gives the Bible's most vivid description of drunkenness and its effects, and it teaches that the wise do not let any appetite rule them. This lesson covers the deception of strong drink, the wisdom of abstaining, and self-control over every appetite.

**MAIN PASSAGES:** Proverbs 20:1; 23:19–21, 29–35; 31:4–7

**KEY VERSE | Proverbs 20:1 —** *Wine is a mocker, strong drink is raging: and whosoever is deceived thereby is not wise.*

**READ:** Proverbs 20:1; 21:17; 23:1–3, 19–21, 29–35; 25:16, 27–28; 31:4–7; Genesis 9:20–27; Isaiah 5:11, 22; 28:7; Habakkuk 2:15; Romans 13:13–14; 1 Corinthians 6:12, 19–20; 9:25–27; Galatians 5:19–23; Ephesians 5:18.

## Wisdom from Proverbs

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Strong drink deceives | Proverbs 20:1 — ***"Wine is a mocker, strong drink is raging"*** |
| Do not look at it | Proverbs 23:31 — ***"Look not thou upon the wine when it is red"*** |
| It bites in the end | Proverbs 23:32 — ***"At the last it biteth like a serpent, and stingeth like an adder."*** |

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| It leads to poverty | Proverbs 23:21 — ***"For the drunkard and the glutton shall come to poverty"*** |
| Leaders must abstain | Proverbs 31:4 — ***"it is not for kings to drink wine; nor for princes strong drink"*** |
| Rule every appetite | Proverbs 23:2 — ***"put a knife to thy throat, if thou be a man given to appetite"*** |

## 1. The Deception of Strong Drink

Proverbs calls wine a **mocker** and strong drink raging, and it adds, ***"whosoever is deceived thereby is not wise"***. Alcohol mocks the one who uses it: it promises fun, confidence, and relief, and then delivers shame, foolishness, and bondage. The deception is that no one thinks he will become the drunkard; every drunkard began with a **first** drink.

Proverbs 23:29–35 gives a detailed description of the one who tarries long at the wine. It begins with six questions: ***"Who hath woe? who hath sorrow? who hath contentions? who hath babbling? who hath wounds without cause? who hath redness of eyes?"*** The answer is those who linger at the wine and go to seek mixed wine (Proverbs 23:30). The same effects follow drugs, marijuana, and every substance that takes control of the mind.

### The Effects of Strong Drink (Proverbs 23:29–35)

| Effect | Verse |
|---|---|
| Woe, sorrow, contentions, and babbling | Proverbs 23:29 |
| Wounds without cause and redness of eyes | Proverbs 23:29 |
| It bites like a serpent and stings like an adder | Proverbs 23:32 |

| Effect | Verse |
|---|---|
| Eyes behold strange women; the heart utters perverse things | Proverbs 23:33 |
| Loss of balance and awareness, like one lying in the sea | Proverbs 23:34–35 |
| Bondage: "I will seek it yet again" | Proverbs 23:35 |

## 2. The Wisdom of Abstaining

Proverbs does not tell the young man to drink carefully; it tells him, ***"Look not thou upon the wine when it is red, when it giveth his colour in the cup, when it moveth itself aright"***. The safest distance from what bites like a serpent is to never pick it up. The command to kings is the same: ***"Lest they drink, and forget the law, and pervert the judgment of any of the afflicted"***.

Believers in the church age are called kings and priests unto God (Revelation 1:6), and their bodies are temples of the Holy Ghost (1 Corinthians 6:19). The Bible's picture of the believer is a clear mind under the control of God's Spirit, not a mind under the control of a substance: ***"And be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit"***. For those reasons Bible-believing Christians have long chosen total **abstinence** from alcohol and from every mind-altering substance.

### Why the Wise Abstain

| Reason | Scripture |
|---|---|
| It deceives | Proverbs 20:1 |
| God says not to look on it | Proverbs 23:31 |
| It clouds judgment | Proverbs 31:4–5; Isaiah 28:7 |

| Reason | Scripture |
| --- | --- |
| The body is the temple of the Holy Ghost | 1 Corinthians 6:19–20 |
| The believer is to be Spirit-filled, not controlled | Ephesians 5:18 |
| It can cause others to stumble | Romans 14:21 |

## 3. Self-Control Over Every Appetite

Proverbs applies the same wisdom to every appetite. It warns against gluttony alongside drunkenness (Proverbs 23:20–21) and tells the man at the ruler's table to ***"put a knife to thy throat, if thou be a man given to appetite"***. Even good things become harmful without restraint: ***"Hast thou found honey? eat so much as is sufficient for thee, lest thou be filled therewith, and vomit it"***.

This principle reaches to anything that can master a young person: food, entertainment, gaming, screens, or pleasure itself. ***"He that loveth pleasure shall be a poor man"***. Paul wrote, ***"But I keep under my body, and bring it into subjection"***. Temperance is part of the fruit of the Spirit (Galatians 5:23), and it grows as the believer walks in the Spirit.

> **Proverbs 25:28 —** *He that hath no rule over his own spirit is like a city that is broken down, and without walls.*

## Check Your Understanding

1. Why does Proverbs call wine a mocker? What does it promise and what does it deliver?
2. List four effects of strong drink from Proverbs 23:29–35.
3. What command does Proverbs 23:31 give, and why is distance the wisest choice?
4. How do Proverbs 31:4–5, 1 Corinthians 6:19, and Ephesians 5:18 support abstaining from alcohol and drugs?
5. Name two appetites other than alcohol that Proverbs warns us to control.

UNIT 3 — WISDOM IN SELF-CONTROL

# Lesson 9 — Go to the Ant: Diligence, Laziness, and Excuses

**Lesson Overview:** Proverbs contrasts two kinds of people in every area of work: the sluggard and the diligent. The sluggard is not always idle; he is full of excuses, delays, and good intentions that never become action. The diligent person works steadily, plans ahead, and finishes what he starts. These principles apply to schoolwork, chores, jobs, and the service of God.

**MAIN PASSAGES:** Proverbs 6:6–11; 10:4–5; 12:24, 27; 13:4; 20:4, 13; 24:30–34; 26:13–16

**KEY VERSE | Proverbs 6:6 —** *Go to the ant, thou sluggard; consider her ways, and be wise:*

**READ:** Proverbs 6:6–11; 10:4–5, 26; 12:11, 24, 27; 13:4; 14:23; 15:19; 18:9; 19:15, 24; 20:4, 13; 21:5, 25–26; 22:13, 29; 24:30–34; 26:13–16; 27:23–27; 28:19; Ecclesiastes 9:10; Colossians 3:23–24; 2 Thessalonians 3:10–12.

## Wisdom from Proverbs

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Learn from the ant | Proverbs 6:6 — ***"Go to the ant, thou sluggard; consider her ways, and be wise:"*** |
| Diligence makes rich | Proverbs 10:4 — ***"the hand of the diligent maketh rich"*** |
| Labor brings profit | Proverbs 14:23 — ***"In all labour there is profit: but the talk of the lips tendeth only to penury"*** |

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Desire without work | Proverbs 13:4 — ***"The soul of the sluggard desireth, and hath nothing"*** |
| Excuses are foolish | Proverbs 22:13 — ***"The slothful man saith, There is a lion without"*** |
| Skill is honored | Proverbs 22:29 — ***"Seest thou a man diligent in his business? he shall stand before kings"*** |

## 1. Lessons from the Ant

God sends the sluggard to school with an insect: ***"Go to the ant, thou sluggard; consider her ways, and be wise"***. The ant has ***"no guide, overseer, or ruler"***, yet she works without being told. She ***"Provideth her meat in the summer, and gathereth her food in the harvest"***. She works ahead, not at the last minute.

The sluggard's problem is not that he plans to fail; it is that he keeps postponing: ***"Yet a little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to sleep"***. Poverty comes on him ***"as one that travelleth, and thy want as an armed man"***. Small delays add up to large losses.

### What the Ant Teaches

| Lesson | Verse |
|---|---|
| Self-motivation: she works without a supervisor | Proverbs 6:7 |
| Planning ahead: she prepares in summer for winter | Proverbs 6:8 |
| Seizing the season: she gathers in harvest | Proverbs 6:8; 10:5 |
| Steady work: little by little | Proverbs 13:11; 30:25 |

## 2. The Portrait of the Sluggard

Proverbs paints a detailed picture of the sluggard so that young people will recognize him in themselves. He desires much but has **nothing** (Proverbs 13:4). He will not plow because it is cold (Proverbs 20:4). He is so lazy that he will not even bring his hand to his mouth (Proverbs 19:24). He turns on his bed like a door on its hinges (Proverbs 26:14). And he is convinced he is right: ***"The sluggard is wiser in his own conceit than seven men that can render a reason"***.

Solomon walked past the field of the slothful and saw it overgrown with thorns and nettles, its stone wall broken down (Proverbs 24:30–31). ***"Then I saw, and considered it well: I looked upon it, and received instruction"***. Neglect does not destroy all at once; it slowly lets the weeds take over.

### The Sluggard's Excuses and Habits

| Habit | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Wishing without working | Proverbs 13:4; 21:25 |
| Blaming conditions: "It's too cold" | Proverbs 20:4 |
| Imagining dangers: "There is a lion in the way" | Proverbs 22:13; 26:13 |
| Loving sleep | Proverbs 20:13; 26:14 |
| Not finishing: will not bring his hand to his mouth | Proverbs 19:24; 26:15 |
| Thinking himself wise | Proverbs 26:16 |
| Wasting what he has | Proverbs 12:27; 18:9 |

## 3. The Blessing of Diligence

Diligence is steady, careful, persistent effort. Proverbs promises that ***"The hand of the diligent shall bear rule: but the slothful shall be under tribute"***. The diligent gain substance (Proverbs 12:27), are made fat (Proverbs 13:4), and ***"shall stand before kings"***. Faithfulness in small duties now prepares a young person for larger responsibilities later.

For the believer, all work is ultimately done for the Lord. ***"And whatsoever ye do, do it heartily, as to the Lord, and not unto men"***. Solomon wrote, ***"Whatsoever thy hand findeth to do, do it with thy might"***. Homework, chores, a job, and service in the church are all opportunities to glorify God through diligence.

### The Diligent and the Slothful Compared

| The diligent | The slothful | Proverb |
|---|---|---|
| Made rich | Becomes poor | Proverbs 10:4 |
| Bears rule | Under tribute | Proverbs 12:24 |
| Made fat | Desires and has nothing | Proverbs 13:4 |
| His way is made plain | His way is an hedge of thorns | Proverbs 15:19 |
| Thoughts tend to plenteousness | Hasty and in want | Proverbs 21:5 |

## Check Your Understanding

1. What four lessons does the ant teach in Proverbs 6:6–8?
2. How does "a little sleep, a little slumber" lead to poverty?
3. List four habits or excuses of the sluggard from Proverbs.
4. What did Solomon learn from the field of the slothful in Proverbs 24:30–34?
5. How does Colossians 3:23 change the way a believer does schoolwork and chores?

UNIT 4 — WISDOM FOR THE FUTURE

# Lesson 10 — Better Than Gold: Money, Integrity, and a Good Name

**Lesson Overview:** Proverbs speaks often about money, but it speaks even more about the character behind it. Honest scales, a good name, generosity, and contentment are worth more than riches gained the wrong way. This lesson covers three connected principles: walk in integrity, handle money wisely, and value a good name and godly character above wealth.

**MAIN PASSAGES:** Proverbs 3:9–10; 10:9; 11:1–3, 24–25; 13:11; 22:1, 7; 23:4–5; 30:7–9

**KEY VERSE | Proverbs 22:1 —** *A good name is rather to be chosen than great riches, and loving favour rather than silver and gold.*

**READ:** Proverbs 3:9–10, 27–28; 10:2, 9, 22; 11:1–3, 24–28; 13:7, 11, 22; 15:16–17, 27; 16:8, 11, 16; 19:1, 17; 20:10, 17, 21, 23; 21:6, 13, 20; 22:1, 7, 9, 16, 26–27; 23:4–5; 28:6, 8, 20, 22, 27; 30:7–9; Luke 16:10–12; 1 Timothy 6:6–10.

## Wisdom from Proverbs

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Integrity keeps you safe | Proverbs 10:9 — ***"He that walketh uprightly walketh surely"*** |
| God hates dishonesty | Proverbs 11:1 — ***"A false balance is abomination to the LORD: but a just weight is his delight."*** |
| Honour God first | Proverbs 3:9 — ***"Honour the LORD with thy substance, and with the firstfruits of all thine increase:"*** |

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Riches fly away | Proverbs 23:4 — ***"Labour not to be rich"*** |
| Generosity increases | Proverbs 11:25 — ***"The liberal soul shall be made fat"*** |
| A good name is better | Proverbs 22:1 — ***"A good name is rather to be chosen than great riches"*** |

## 1. Walk in Integrity

Integrity means being the same person in private as in public, whole and undivided in doing right. ***"The integrity of the upright shall guide them: but the perverseness of transgressors shall destroy them"***. The person of integrity does not have to remember which lie he told to whom. ***"He that walketh uprightly walketh surely: but he that perverteth his ways shall be known"***.

Proverbs repeatedly condemns cheating: false balances, divers weights, and bread gained by deceit (Proverbs 11:1; 20:10, 23). Cheating on a test, lying on a form, and taking what is not ours are modern forms of a false balance. ***"Bread of deceit is sweet to a man; but afterwards his mouth shall be filled with gravel"***.

### Honesty and Dishonesty

| Honesty | Dishonesty | Proverb |
|---|---|---|
| A just weight is His delight | A false balance is abomination | Proverbs 11:1 |
| The upright are guided | Transgressors are destroyed | Proverbs 11:3 |
| Walking uprightly is secure | Perverse ways are exposed | Proverbs 10:9 |
| Better poor with integrity | Than perverse in lips and a fool | Proverbs 19:1; 28:6 |
| Righteousness delivers from death | Treasures of wickedness profit nothing | Proverbs 10:2 |

## 2. Handle Money Wisely

Proverbs gives practical principles for money that every young person should learn before earning a first paycheck. Honour the LORD **first** (Proverbs 3:9–10). Build wealth slowly through labor rather than quickly through schemes (Proverbs 13:11; 28:20). Save rather than spend everything (Proverbs 21:20). Avoid debt and co-signing (Proverbs 22:7, 26–27). Be generous to the poor (Proverbs 19:17).

Proverbs also warns against making money the goal of life: ***"Labour not to be rich: cease from thine own wisdom"***. ***"for riches certainly make themselves wings; they fly away as an eagle toward heaven"***. Agur prayed for balance: ***"give me neither poverty nor riches; feed me with food convenient for me"***, lest riches make him deny God or poverty tempt him to steal (Proverbs 30:9).

### Proverbs' Principles for Money

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Honour the LORD with the firstfruits | Proverbs 3:9–10 |
| Gather by labour, little by little | Proverbs 13:11 |
| Do not hasten to be rich | Proverbs 28:20, 22 |
| Save; do not consume everything | Proverbs 21:20 |
| The borrower is servant to the lender | Proverbs 22:7 |
| Do not become surety for debts | Proverbs 22:26–27 |
| He that giveth to the poor lendeth unto the LORD | Proverbs 19:17 |

## 3. A Good Name and True Riches

A reputation takes years to build and moments to destroy. ***"A good name is rather to be chosen than great riches, and loving favour rather than silver and gold"***. Every

choice a young person makes, including what he posts and how he treats others, is building or tearing down his name.

Proverbs points to riches that money cannot buy. Wisdom is better than gold (Proverbs 16:16). A little with the fear of the LORD is better than great treasure with trouble (Proverbs 15:16). ***"The blessing of the LORD, it maketh rich, and he addeth no sorrow with it"***. The Lord Jesus asked, ***"For what shall it profit a man, if he shall gain the whole world, and lose his own soul?"***

### What Is Better Than Riches

| Better | Proverb |
|---|---|
| A good name and loving favour | Proverbs 22:1 |
| Wisdom and understanding | Proverbs 16:16 |
| A little with the fear of the LORD | Proverbs 15:16 |
| A dinner of herbs where love is | Proverbs 15:17 |
| A little with righteousness | Proverbs 16:8 |
| The poor that walketh in his uprightness | Proverbs 28:6 |

> **Proverbs 16:16 —** *How much better is it to get wisdom than gold! and to get understanding rather to be chosen than silver!*

## Check Your Understanding

1. What is integrity, and what does Proverbs 11:3 and 10:9 promise to the one who walks in it?
2. What are some modern forms of a "false balance"?
3. List five principles for handling money from Proverbs.
4. What did Agur ask for in Proverbs 30:7–9, and why?
5. Name three things Proverbs says are better than riches.

UNIT 4 — WISDOM FOR THE FUTURE

# Lesson 11 — The Path of Life: Decisions, Plans, and God's Direction

**Lesson Overview:** High school is a season of big decisions: college, career, relationships, and the direction of life. Proverbs teaches that man plans but God directs, that the wise seek counsel, and that the path of the righteous grows brighter over time. This lesson covers how to make decisions wisely, how to plan while trusting God, and how to stay on the right path.

**MAIN PASSAGES:** Proverbs 3:5–6; 4:18–27; 11:14; 14:12; 15:22; 16:1–3, 9, 33; 19:20–21; 27:1

**KEY VERSE | Proverbs 16:9 —** *A man's heart deviseth his way: but the LORD directeth his steps.*

**READ:** Proverbs 3:5–7; 4:18–27; 11:14; 12:15; 14:8, 12, 15; 15:22; 16:1–3, 9, 25, 33; 19:2, 20–21; 20:18, 24; 21:30–31; 22:3; 24:3–6, 27; 27:1, 12; Psalm 37:23; James 4:13–15.

## Wisdom from Proverbs

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Commit your plans to God | Proverbs 16:3 — ***"Commit thy works unto the LORD, and thy thoughts shall be established."*** |
| God directs the steps | Proverbs 16:9 — ***"A man's heart deviseth his way: but the LORD directeth his steps."*** |
| His counsel stands | Proverbs 19:21 — ***"the counsel of the LORD, that shall stand"*** |

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Seek counsel | Proverbs 15:22 — ***"in the multitude of counsellors they are established"*** |
| Look ahead | Proverbs 22:3 — ***"A prudent man foreseeth the evil, and hideth himself"*** |
| Do not boast of tomorrow | Proverbs 27:1 — ***"Boast not thyself of to morrow; for thou knowest not what a day may bring forth."*** |

## 1. Man Plans, God Directs

Proverbs does not tell young people to stop planning; it tells them to plan under God. ***"A man's heart deviseth his way: but the LORD directeth his steps"***. ***"There are many devices in a man's heart; nevertheless the counsel of the LORD, that shall stand"***. Even what seems like chance is under His control: ***"The lot is cast into the lap; but the whole disposing thereof is of the LORD"***.

That truth brings both humility and peace. It brings humility because our plans are not final (Proverbs 27:1; James 4:13–15). It brings peace because the One directing our steps is wise and good. ***"Commit thy works unto the LORD, and thy thoughts shall be established"***.

### God's Sovereignty Over Our Plans

| Truth | Proverb |
|---|---|
| The preparations of the heart are from the LORD | Proverbs 16:1 |
| The LORD directs a man's steps | Proverbs 16:9; 20:24 |
| The counsel of the LORD shall stand | Proverbs 19:21 |

| Truth | Proverb |
|---|---|
| No wisdom or counsel succeeds against the LORD | Proverbs 21:30 |
| Safety is of the LORD | Proverbs 21:31 |

## 2. How the Wise Make Decisions

Proverbs gives clear principles for making decisions. First, beware of the way that only seems right: ***"There is a way which seemeth right unto a man, but the end thereof are the ways of death"***. Second, do not rush: ***"he that hasteth with his feet sinneth"***. Third, look ahead to consequences: ***"the prudent man looketh well to his going"***.

Fourth, seek godly counsel. ***"Where no counsel is, the people fall: but in the multitude of counsellors there is safety"***. Parents, pastors, and mature believers can see what a young person cannot yet see. ***"The way of a fool is right in his own eyes: but he that hearkeneth unto counsel is wise"***. Finally, build in the right order: ***"Prepare thy work without, and make it fit for thyself in the field; and afterwards build thine house"***.

### Decision Principles from Proverbs

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Acknowledge God in all your ways | Proverbs 3:6 |
| Distrust the way that only seems right | Proverbs 14:12; 16:25 |
| Take time; do not rush | Proverbs 19:2; 21:5 |
| Consider the end, not only the start | Proverbs 14:15; 22:3 |
| Seek many godly counsellors | Proverbs 11:14; 15:22; 20:18 |
| Prepare first, then build | Proverbs 24:3–4, 27 |

## 3. Staying on the Path of Life

Proverbs describes the life of the righteous as a path that grows brighter: ***"But the path of the just is as the shining light, that shineth more and more unto the perfect day"***. The wicked walk in darkness and do not even know what makes them stumble (Proverbs 4:19).

To stay on that path requires focus and ongoing care. ***"Let thine eyes look right on, and let thine eyelids look straight before thee"***. ***"Ponder the path of thy feet, and let all thy ways be established"***. ***"Turn not to the right hand nor to the left: remove thy foot from evil"***. A young person who keeps God's Word before him will find that ***"The steps of a good man are ordered by the LORD"***.

> **Proverbs 3:6 —** *In all thy ways acknowledge him, and he shall direct thy paths.*

## Check Your Understanding

1. What does Proverbs 16:9 and 19:21 teach about our plans and God's direction?
2. Why should we be careful with "the way which seemeth right" (Proverbs 14:12)?
3. List five principles for making wise decisions from Proverbs.
4. Why is seeking counsel a mark of wisdom? Use Proverbs 11:14 and 12:15.
5. How does Proverbs 4:18–27 describe staying on the path of life?

UNIT 4 — WISDOM FOR THE FUTURE

# Lesson 12 — Christ, the Wisdom of God: The Choice That Matters Most

**Lesson Overview:** Proverbs is not only a book of good advice. Its wisdom points to a Person. The New Testament reveals that Jesus Christ is the wisdom of God, in whom are hid all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge. This final lesson sees Christ pictured in Proverbs 8 and 30, returns to the two invitations of Proverbs 9, and calls every young person to receive the One who is Wisdom and to share Him with others.

**MAIN PASSAGES:** Proverbs 8:1–36; 9:1–18; 30:4; 1 Corinthians 1:18–31; Colossians 2:3

**KEY VERSE | 1 Corinthians 1:30 —** *But of him are ye in Christ Jesus, who of God is made unto us wisdom, and righteousness, and sanctification, and redemption:*

**READ:** Proverbs 1:20–33; 8:1–36; 9:1–18; 11:30; 14:12; 30:4–5; John 1:1–3; 14:6; 1 Corinthians 1:18–31; Colossians 1:15–17; 2:2–3; James 1:5; 3:17.

## Wisdom from Scripture

| Truth | Scripture |
|---|---|
| Christ is God's wisdom | 1 Corinthians 1:24 — ***"Christ the power of God, and the wisdom of God"*** |
| All treasure is in Him | Colossians 2:3 — ***"In whom are hid all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge."*** |
| Wisdom was with God | Proverbs 8:30 — ***"Then I was by him, as one brought up with him"*** |

| Truth | Scripture |
|---|---|
| Finding wisdom is finding life | Proverbs 8:35 — ***"For whoso findeth me findeth life, and shall obtain favour of the LORD."*** |
| What is His Son's name? | Proverbs 30:4 — ***"what is his name, and what is his son's name, if thou canst tell?"*** |
| The wise win souls | Proverbs 11:30 — ***"he that winneth souls is wise"*** |

## 1. Wisdom in Proverbs 8 and the Son in Proverbs 30

In Proverbs 8 wisdom speaks as a person. Wisdom was set up from everlasting, before the earth was (Proverbs 8:23). When God prepared the heavens, wisdom was there (Proverbs 8:27). ***"Then I was by him, as one brought up with him: and I was daily his delight, rejoicing always before him"***. The New Testament applies this language to the Lord Jesus Christ, the eternal Word who was with God in the beginning and by whom all things were made (John 1:1–3; Colossians 1:16–17).

Proverbs 30:4 asks a series of questions that only God can answer: who has ascended into heaven, gathered the wind, bound the waters, and established the ends of the earth? Then it asks, ***"what is his name, and what is his son's name, if thou canst tell?"*** The Old Testament raised the question; the New Testament answers it with the name of **Jesus Christ**, the only begotten Son of God (John 3:16).

### Wisdom in Proverbs 8 and Christ in the New Testament

| Proverbs 8 | Fulfilled in Christ |
|---|---|
| Set up from everlasting (8:23) | In the beginning was the Word (John 1:1) |
| Present at creation (8:27–30) | All things were made by Him (John 1:3; Colossians 1:16) |

| Proverbs 8 | Fulfilled in Christ |
|---|---|
| Daily God's delight (8:30) | “This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased” (Matthew 3:17) |
| Speaks excellent things and truth (8:6–7) | Grace and truth came by Jesus Christ (John 1:17) |
| Whoso findeth me findeth life (8:35) | He that hath the Son hath life (1 John 5:12) |

## 2. Two Invitations (Proverbs 9)

Proverbs 9 closes the opening section of the book with two banquets. Wisdom has built her house, prepared her table, and sent out her maidens: ***“Whoso is simple, let him turn in hither”***. ***“Forsake the foolish, and live; and go in the way of understanding”***. The foolish woman sits at the door of her house and calls to the same passersby with the same words (Proverbs 9:13–16), offering stolen waters and secret bread (Proverbs 9:17).

Every young person hears both invitations. The world offers pleasure, freedom, and secrecy; Wisdom offers life. The difference is the destination: ***“But he knoweth not that the dead are there; and that her guests are in the depths of hell”***. The Lord Jesus gave the same choice between the broad way and the narrow way (Matthew 7:13–14).

### The Two Invitations

| | Wisdom | Folly |
|---|---|---|
| Her house | Built on seven pillars (9:1) | She sits at the door (9:14) |
| Her offer | Bread and mingled wine (9:5) | Stolen waters and secret bread (9:17) |
| Her call | “Forsake the foolish, and live” (9:6) | “Whoso is simple, let him turn in hither” (9:16) |

| | Wisdom | Folly |
|---|---|---|
| Her guests' end | Days multiplied; years of life increased (9:11) | The dead are there; the depths of hell (9:18) |

## 3. Receiving Wisdom and Winning Souls

True wisdom begins not with a better set of rules but with a new **birth**. The world's wisdom cannot save anyone: ***"For after that in the wisdom of God the world by wisdom knew not God, it pleased God by the foolishness of preaching to save them that believe"***. Christ ***"of God is made unto us wisdom, and righteousness, and sanctification, and redemption"***. A person receives Him by believing the gospel: that Christ died for our sins, was buried, and rose again the third day (1 Corinthians 15:3–4).

Once a young person has received Christ, he can ask God for wisdom in every decision: ***"If any of you lack wisdom, let him ask of God, that giveth to all men liberally, and upbraideth not; and it shall be given him"***. The wisest thing a believer can do with his life is to bring others to the Saviour. ***"The fruit of the righteous is a tree of life; and he that winneth souls is wise"***.

### The Wisdom from Above (James 3:17)

| Quality | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Pure | Clean and free from sin |
| Peaceable | Seeks peace, not strife |
| Gentle | Kind and reasonable |
| Easy to be intreated | Willing to listen and yield |
| Full of mercy and good fruits | Shows compassion in action |

| Quality | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Without partiality, without hypocrisy | Sincere and fair to all |

**Proverbs 8:17** — *I love them that love me; and those that seek me early shall find me.*

## Check Your Understanding

1. How does the description of wisdom in Proverbs 8:22–31 point to the Lord Jesus Christ?
2. What question does Proverbs 30:4 ask, and how does the New Testament answer it?
3. Compare the two invitations of Proverbs 9. Where does each one lead?
4. According to 1 Corinthians 1:21–30, how does a person receive the wisdom of God?
5. Why does Proverbs 11:30 say that he that winneth souls is wise?

REFERENCE APPENDIX

# Appendix A — Proverbs in a Month

Read the chapter that matches the day of the month. In one year you will read the whole book of Proverbs twelve times.

| Day | Chapter | Theme |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Proverbs 1 | Wisdom's call and the enticement of sinners |
| 2 | Proverbs 2 | Searching for wisdom as for silver |
| 3 | Proverbs 3 | Trust in the LORD; wisdom more precious than rubies |
| 4 | Proverbs 4 | The path of the just; keep thy heart |
| 5 | Proverbs 5 | The strange woman; rejoice with the wife of thy youth |
| 6 | Proverbs 6 | The ant; seven things the LORD hates |
| 7 | Proverbs 7 | The young man void of understanding |
| 8 | Proverbs 8 | Wisdom at creation; whoso findeth me findeth life |
| 9 | Proverbs 9 | Wisdom's house and Folly's house |
| 10 | Proverbs 10 | The wise son and the mouth of the righteous |
| 11 | Proverbs 11 | Integrity, generosity, and winning souls |
| 12 | Proverbs 12 | Loving instruction; lips of truth |
| 13 | Proverbs 13 | Companions, diligence, and hope deferred |
| 14 | Proverbs 14 | The way that seemeth right; the fear of the LORD |
| 15 | Proverbs 15 | The soft answer; better is little |
| 16 | Proverbs 16 | The LORD directs the steps; pride before destruction |

| Day | Chapter | Theme |
|---|---|---|
| 17 | Proverbs 17 | Friendship, strife, and a merry heart |
| 18 | Proverbs 18 | The power of the tongue; a friend closer than a brother |
| 19 | Proverbs 19 | Poor with integrity; hearing counsel |
| 20 | Proverbs 20 | Wine is a mocker; honest weights |
| 21 | Proverbs 21 | The king's heart; the sluggard's desire |
| 22 | Proverbs 22 | A good name; train up a child |
| 23 | Proverbs 23 | Riches fly away; wine when it is red |
| 24 | Proverbs 24 | Envy not the wicked; the field of the slothful |
| 25 | Proverbs 25 | Words fitly spoken; rule over your spirit |
| 26 | Proverbs 26 | The fool, the sluggard, and the talebearer |
| 27 | Proverbs 27 | Boast not of tomorrow; iron sharpeneth iron |
| 28 | Proverbs 28 | Bold as a lion; confessing and forsaking sin |
| 29 | Proverbs 29 | Hardened after reproof; the fear of man |
| 30 | Proverbs 30 | Agur's words; what is His Son's name? |
| 31 | Proverbs 31 | Lemuel's mother; the virtuous woman |

REFERENCE APPENDIX

# Appendix B — Memory Verses

Memorize the key verse from each lesson. Hide God's Word in your heart (Psalm 119:11).

| Lesson | Key verse |
|---|---|
| 1 | Proverbs 1:7 — ***"The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge: but fools despise wisdom and instruction."*** |
| 2 | Proverbs 1:8 — ***"My son, hear the instruction of thy father, and forsake not the law of thy mother:"*** |
| 3 | Proverbs 4:23 — ***"Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life."*** |
| 4 | Proverbs 13:20 — ***"He that walketh with wise men shall be wise: but a companion of fools shall be destroyed."*** |
| 5 | Proverbs 31:30 — ***"Favour is deceitful, and beauty is vain: but a woman that feareth the LORD, she shall be praised."*** |
| 6 | Proverbs 18:21 — ***"Death and life are in the power of the tongue: and they that love it shall eat the fruit thereof."*** |
| 7 | Proverbs 16:32 — ***"He that is slow to anger is better than the mighty; and he that ruleth his spirit than he that taketh a city."*** |
| 8 | Proverbs 20:1 — ***"Wine is a mocker, strong drink is raging: and whosoever is deceived thereby is not wise."*** |
| 9 | Proverbs 6:6 — ***"Go to the ant, thou sluggard; consider her ways, and be wise:"*** |

| Lesson | Key verse |
|---|---|
| 10 | Proverbs 22:1 — ***"A good name is rather to be chosen than great riches, and loving favour rather than silver and gold."*** |
| 11 | Proverbs 16:9 — ***"A man's heart deviseth his way: but the LORD directeth his steps."*** |
| 12 | 1 Corinthians 1:30 — ***"But of him are ye in Christ Jesus, who of God is made unto us wisdom, and righteousness, and sanctification, and redemption:"*** |

REFERENCE APPENDIX

# Appendix C — How to Be Saved

Every issue in this workbook finally comes back to one question: Do you know Jesus Christ as your Saviour? Salvation is not earned by religion, good works, or church membership. It is the free gift of God received by faith in the Lord Jesus Christ.

| Truth | Scripture |
|---|---|
| All have sinned | Romans 3:23 — ***"For all have sinned, and come short of the glory of God;"*** |
| Sin brings death | Romans 6:23 — ***"For the wages of sin is death; but the gift of God is eternal life through Jesus Christ our Lord."*** |
| Christ died for sinners | Romans 5:8 — ***"But God commendeth his love toward us, in that, while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us."*** |
| The gospel | 1 Corinthians 15:3–4 — ***"Christ died for our sins according to the scriptures"***; ***"he was buried, and that he rose again the third day"*** |
| Salvation is by grace | Ephesians 2:8–9 — ***"For by grace are ye saved through faith; and that not of yourselves: it is the gift of God: Not of works, lest any man should boast."*** |
| Call on the Lord | Romans 10:13 — ***"For whosoever shall call upon the name of the Lord shall be saved."*** |
| You can know | 1 John 5:13 — ***"These things have I written unto you that believe on the name of the Son of God; that ye may know that ye have eternal life"*** |

| Truth | Scripture |
| --- | --- |
| You are kept for ever | John 10:28 — ***"And I give unto them eternal life; and they shall never perish"*** |

After salvation, a believer should follow the Lord in baptism (Acts 8:36–38), join himself to a sound local church (Acts 2:41–42), and grow by reading and obeying the Word of God (1 Peter 2:2).

> **John 3:16 —** *For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life.*